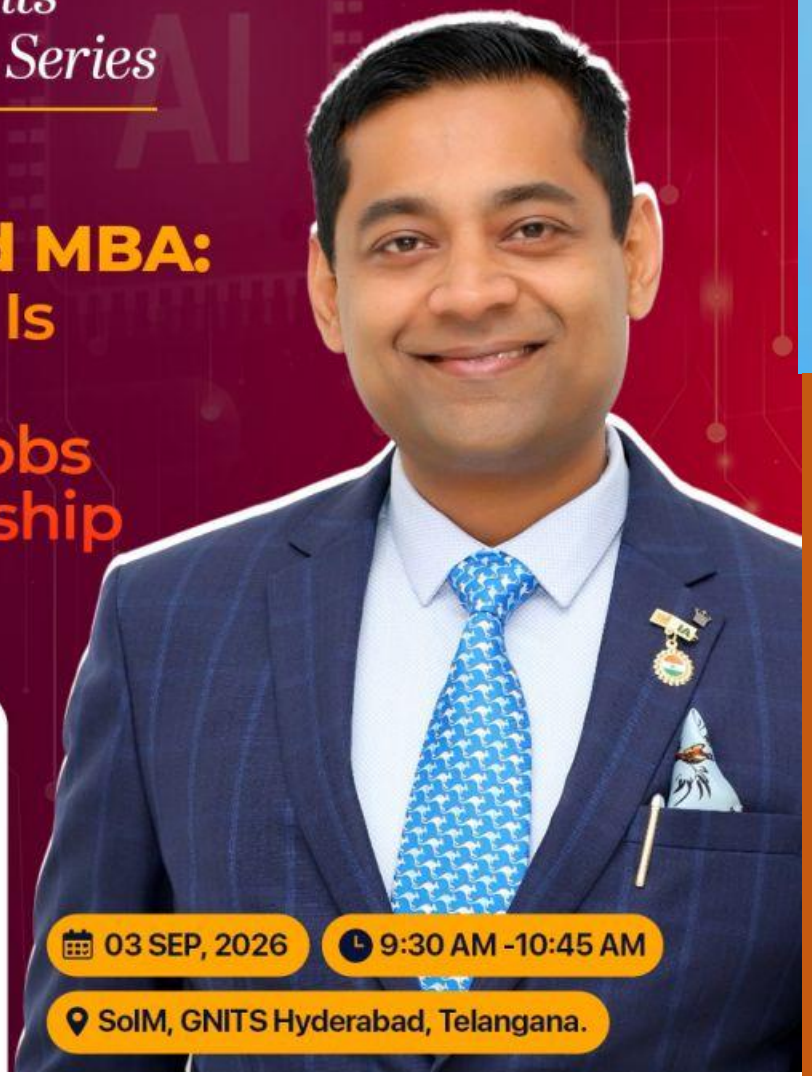
SoIM
School of Innovation and Management
Innovate. Include. Inspire.

SoIM Insights
Leadership Series

TOPIC

AI-Powered MBA: How GenAI Is Redefining Business, Jobs and Leadership in 2026



Dr. Ashish Mittal

Group - CHRO | ASIA'S 100 POWER LEADERS in HR FORBES INDIA TOP 50 HR LEADERS | NCC RD Cadet 1996 | Panel Moderator Keynote, Motivation Speaker | Jury Member Top Leadership Voice

03 SEP, 2026

9:30 AM -10:45 AM

SoIM, GNITS Hyderabad, Telangana.





AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

If two MBA graduates have the same degree, college & experience — but one knows how to work with AI & the other doesn't… who gets hired?





THE MBA IS NO LONGER ENOUGH…

The differentiator is increasingly the ability to <u>create value with AI</u>.

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THE BIG SHIFT

From digital tools to intelligence on demand



- Industrial Age → Machines scaled physical effort
- Internet Age → Software scaled information
- AI Age → Intelligence becomes scalable
- GenAI → Create, Analyse, Summarise, Reason, Converse
- Agentic AI → Plan, Execute, Monitor, Adapt

For the first time, Technology is not just automating work….it is participating in knowledge work.

Microsoft describes the emerging model as **human-agent teams**, where AI agents increasingly perform tasks & humans provide direction, judgment and accountability.

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

THE MBA EVOLUTION

MBA 1.0
Business Knowledge

Finance | Marketing | HR | Operations | Strategy

MBA 2.0
Digital Business

Data | Analytics | Cloud | Platforms

MBA 3.0
AI-Powered Business

AI + Business + Human Skills

MBA 4.0
AI-Native Leader

Humans + AI Agents + Data + Judgment





Human + AI + Data + Judgment

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

WHERE CAN YOU USE GENAI ?

Marketing	Campaigns • Customer personas • Content
Finance	Analysis • Forecasting • Reporting
HR	JD creation • Talent analytics • Learning
Operations	Process optimisation • SOPs
Sales	Lead research • Proposals • CRM intelligence
Strategy	Market research • Scenarios • Competitor analysis
Consulting	Research • Synthesis • Presentations
Entrepreneurship	MVPs • Market validation • Business plans

AI is not a department. AI is becoming a capability across every department.

REAL-WORLD CASE | MICROSOFT



The Frontier Firm -
An advanced, AI-first organization model introduced by Microsoft where employees act as "agent bosses" working alongside autonomous AI systems.

Microsoft 2025 Work Trend Index surveyed 31,000 knowledge workers across 31 markets.

- ✓ 82% of leaders said 2025 was a pivotal year to rethink strategy & operations.
- ✓ 81% expected agents to be extensively integrated into AI strategy within 12 - 18 months.
- ✓ The emerging model: hybrid teams of humans + AI agents.
- ✓ Leaders expect employees increasingly to train & manage AI agents.

TAKEAWAY

Your future team may not consist only of people.

5 employees + 20 AI agents.

REAL-WORLD CASE | CISCO

90,000 employees + AI agents - Cisco case | 2026

Cisco introduced a **personalised AI agent, MyAgent, to approximately 90,000 employees**.

Use cases include email, market analysis & sales forecasting.

Agents operate within permissions & security controls.

Some engineers now **manage multiple AI agents** as part of their daily workflow.

The manager/employee **role shifts** toward orchestration, review & accountability.

The question is no longer "Can AI do the task?" - it is "How do we redesign the workflow?"

REAL-WORLD CASE | SALESFORCE

AI becomes a business line



Salesforce's Agentforce is moving AI from an internal productivity tool to a **commercial product.**

In Q2 FY2027, Agentforce ARR *(annualised recurring revenue)* was reported at $1.5B; broader Agentforce/Data 360 ARR was reported a near $3.9B.

Salesforce is integrating AI deeply into sales, service & marketing workflows.

AI is becoming not just a technology expense , but a revenue stream & competitive advantage.

LESSON **AI can be a product, a capability & a business model.**





THE JOBS QUESTION

WILL AI TAKE YOUR JOB?

Better Question:

Which parts of your job will AI take?

Most jobs are collections of tasks.

AI will reshape tasks first - then roles, workflows & Org's.

WHAT CHANGES IN A MARKETING MANAGER'S JOB?

AI CAN ASSIST WITH

- First-draft content
- Market research
- Customer segmentation
- Campaign variations
- Data analysis



HUMAN VALUE remains CRITICAL

- ✓ Brand judgment
- ✓ Creativity & taste
- ✓ Customer understanding
- ✓ Negotiation
- ✓ Leadership & accountability

AI changes the work — not the need for judgment.

Old MBA - Knowledge + Communication + Management

THE NEW MBA SKILL STACK

BUSINESS KNOWLEDGE + AI FLUENCY + HUMAN SKILLS

- ✓ Data literacy
- ✓ Critical thinking
- ✓ Problem framing
- ✓ Creativity
- ✓ Communication
- ✓ Ethical judgment
- ✓ Leadership



AI + BUSINESS + HUMAN SKILLS

PROMPT ENGINEERING IS NOT ENOUGH

Bad:

Analyse this company.



Better:

Identify the 3 biggest revenue risks over 24 months & provide evidence.

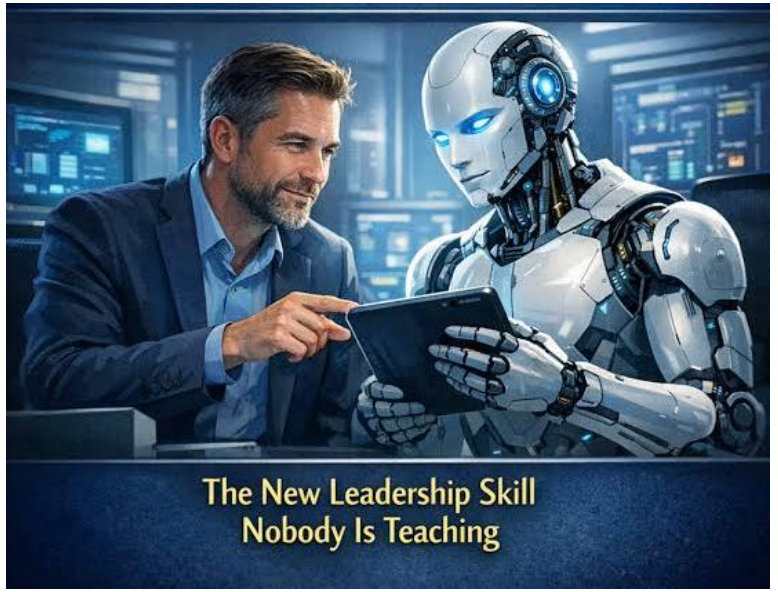
BEST: Frame the business problem → define context → demand evidence → challenge assumptions → rank actions → decide.

Prompting is not the ultimate skill. Problem framing is.

AI WILL CHANGE MANAGEMENT

OLD MANAGER

Assign → Monitor → Review



AI-ERA MANAGER

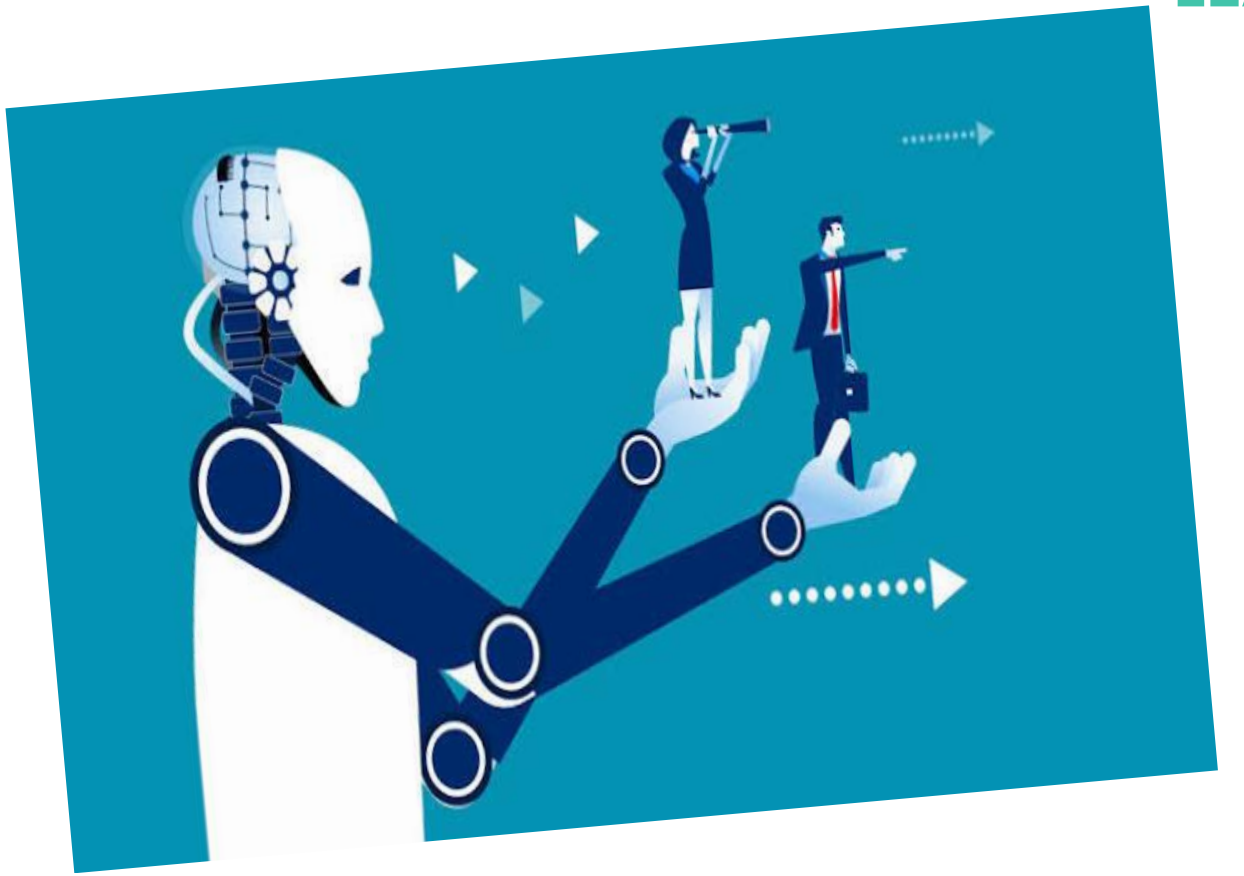
Define outcome → Design workflow → Delegate to humans + AI → Validate → Improve

THE MANAGER BECOMES AN ORCHESTRATOR,
not merely supervisor.

LEADERSHIP IN THE AI ERA

AI CAN PROVIDE

- Speed
- Scale
- Analysis
- Prediction
- Content



LEADERS MUST PROVIDE

- ✓ Vision
- ✓ Trust
- ✓ Courage
- ✓ Empathy
- ✓ Ethics
- ✓ Accountability

AI can generate an answer. Leaders decide whether it is the right answer.

THE MOST IMPORTANT LEADERSHIP SKILL: JUDGMENT

AI

Analyses thousands of data points

→

LEADER

Chooses the direction



→

ACCOUNTABILITY

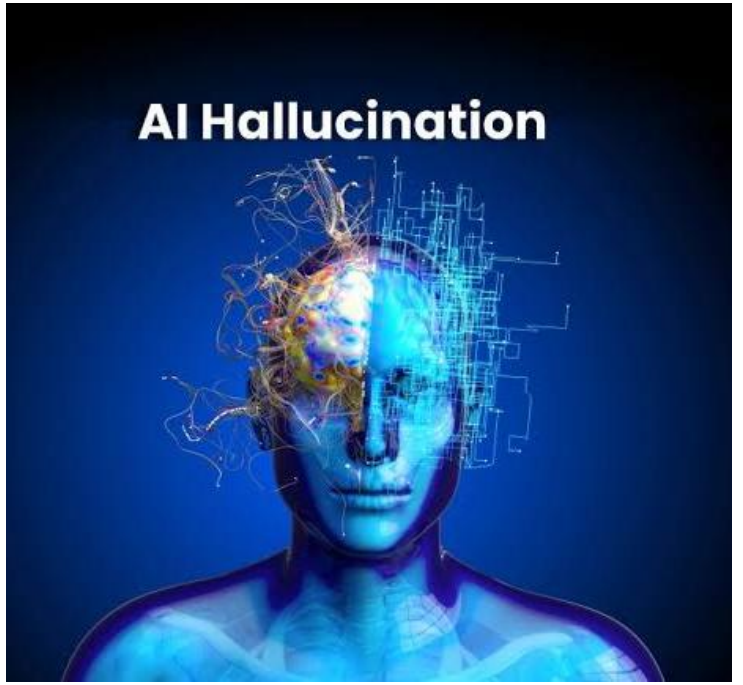
Remains human

The more powerful AI becomes, the more important human judgment becomes.

AI HALLUCINATION = BUSINESS RISK

AI OUTPUT ≠ TRUTH

- Confident but incorrect answers
- Fake references / unsupported claims
- Bias in recommendations
- Outdated information
- Over-reliance without verification



TRUST → VERIFY → DECIDE

Never outsource accountability to AI.

AI + ETHICS



If AI rejects a candidate — who is responsible?

If AI denies a loan — who is responsible?

If AI recommends firing an employee — who is responsible?

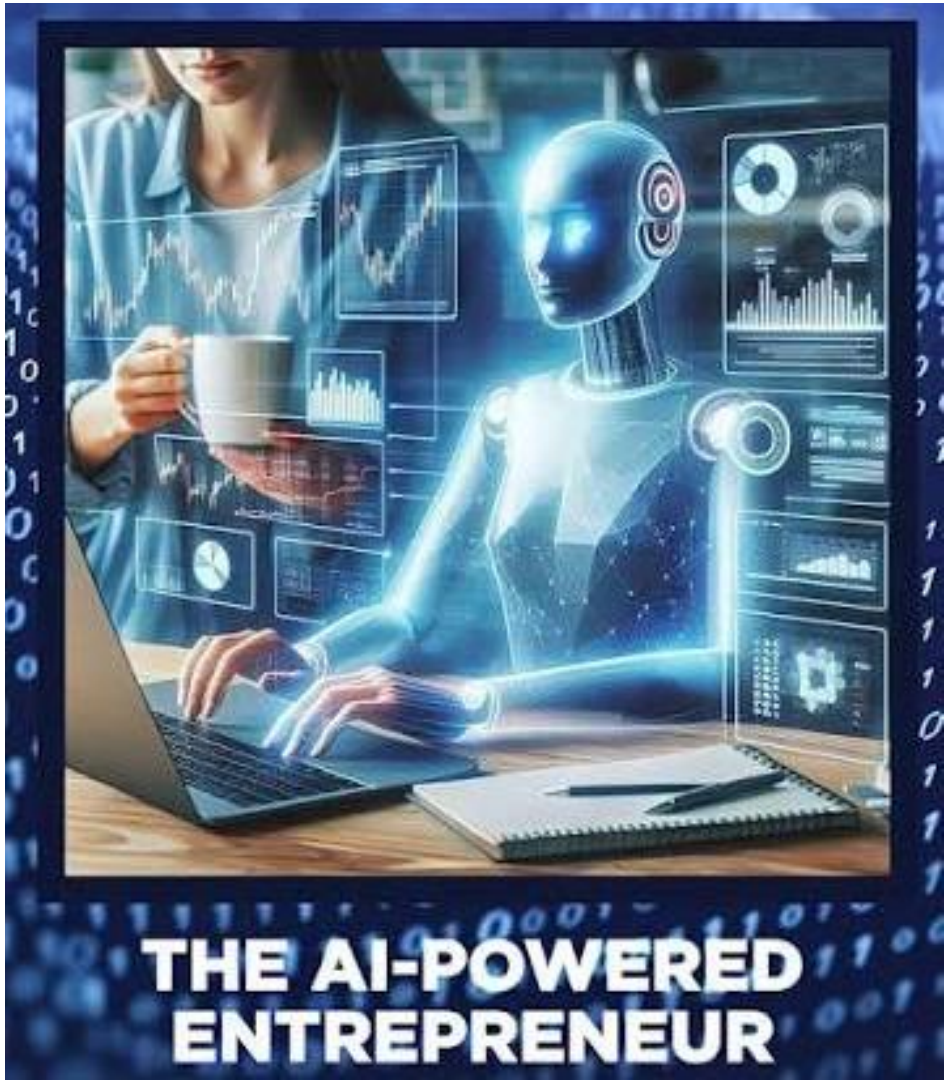
If AI gives incorrect financial advice — who is responsible?

THE ANSWER: THE ORGANISATION — AND ITS LEADERS.

ONE FOUNDER + AI

- ✓ Market research → Business model → Brand → Website
- ✓ Customer research → Content → Sales outreach → Analytics
- ✓ MVP *(Minimum Viable Product)* development → Testing → Iteration → Customer support

AI is lowering the cost of starting a business.



DON'T BECOME AN AI CONTENT GENERATOR

AI makes mediocre work easy.

- 20-page reports
- Beautiful presentations
- LinkedIn posts
- Business plans
- Research summaries



MORE CONTENT ≠ MORE VALUE

Become an AI-powered problem solver.

THE CAREER EQUATION

DEGREE ≠ EMPLOYABILITY

Employability = Knowledge + Skills + Experience +
Adaptability + AI Fluency + Human Skills

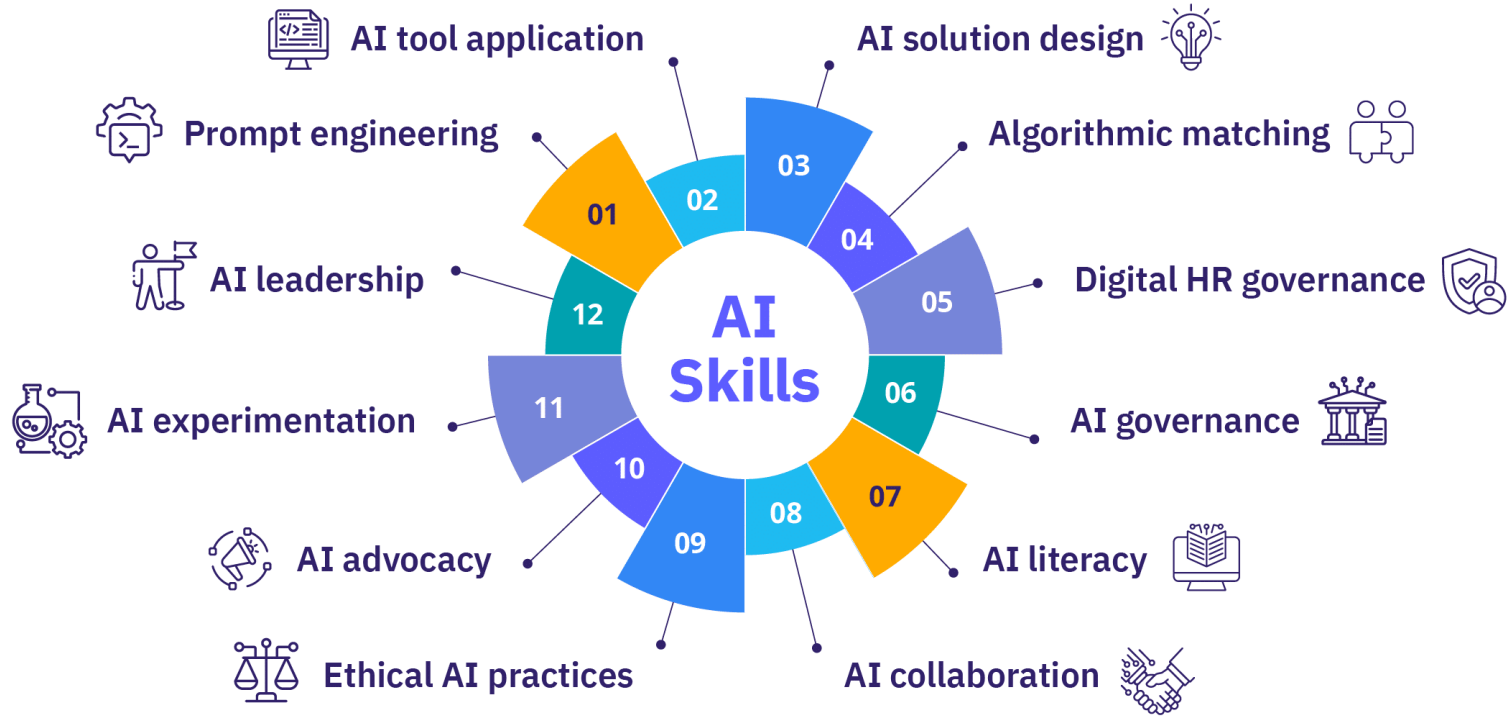


Your MBA gets you the foundation.
Your ability to create value gets you noticed.

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

WHAT RECRUITERS WILL LOOK FOR

1. Can you analyze a market?
2. Can you build a financial model?
3. Can you use AI to research and synthesize?
4. Can you automate a workflow?
5. Can you interpret data?
6. Can you solve a real business problem?
7. Can you communicate, collaborate and lead?



DON'T JUST SAY "AI SKILLS" ON YOUR CV. SHOW THE EVIDENCE.

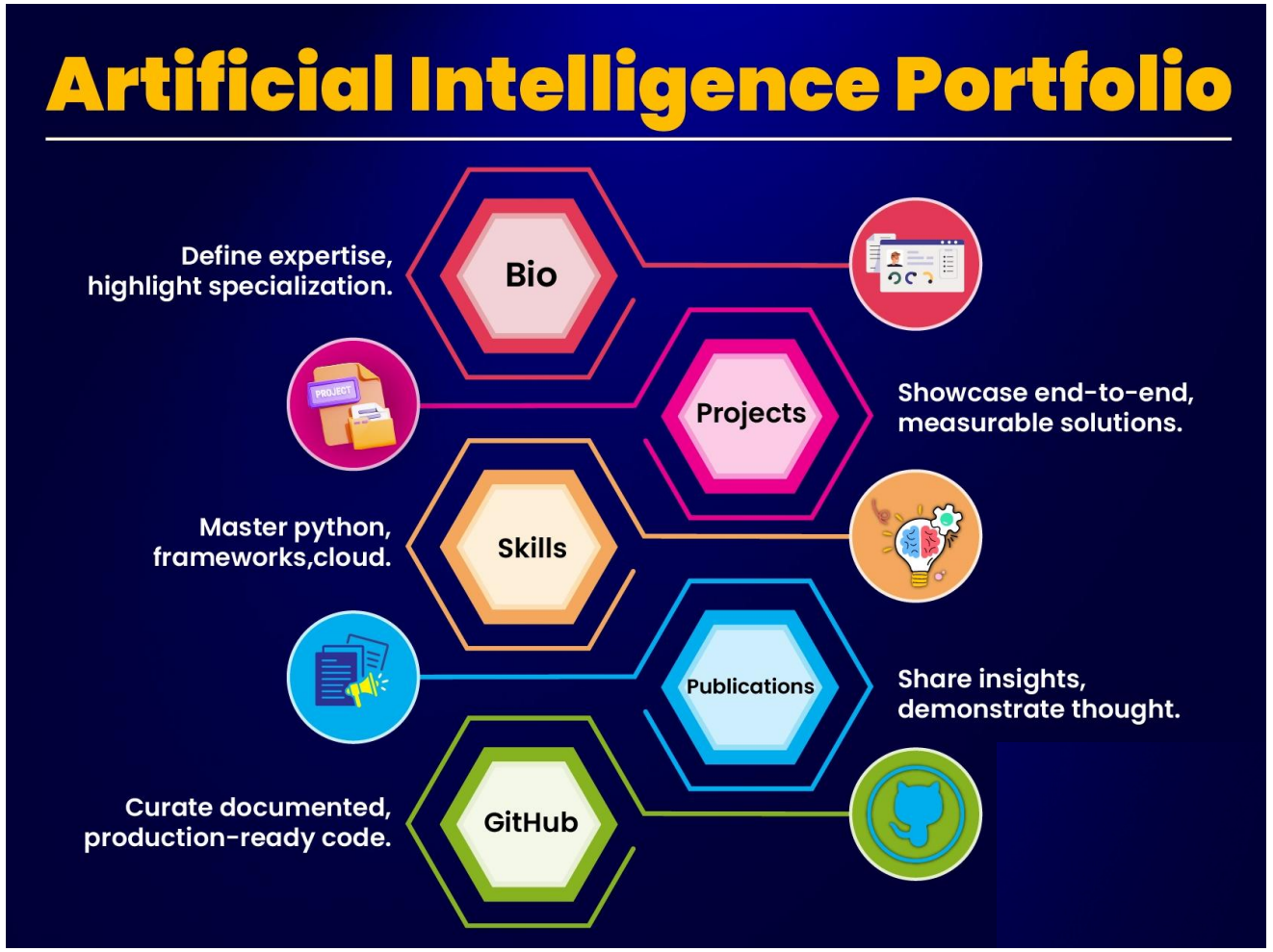
AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

BUILD AN AI PORTFOLIO

BY GRADUATION: 5 AI PROJECTS

1. AI-powered market analysis
2. AI sales / marketing campaign
3. AI HR / talent solution
4. AI financial / business analysis
5. AI-powered startup or business idea

Portfolio > Certificate



AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

30-DAY AI CHALLENGE

Week 1 → Use GenAI every day.

W 2 → Apply AI to your MBA specialization.

Week 3 → Build one AI-powered business solution.

W 4 → Present it against a real business problem.

What business problem can you solve with AI that you could not solve six months ago?



DON'T COMPETE WITH AI.

LEARN TO LEAD AI.



AI + You > You alone

THE FUTURE ORGANISATION

TRADITIONAL

Customer →
Department →
Manager → Process



AI-NATIVE

Customer →
Outcome →
Workflow →
Humans + Agents

Organizations may increasingly be designed around workflows & outcomes — not only org charts.

THE QUESTION IS NOT...

Will AI take my job?

THE REAL QUESTION IS...

Will I become the person who knows how to use AI to create more value?

YOUR MBA → FOUNDATION

AI → LEVERAGE

LEADERSHIP → IMPACT

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)



MBA + AI + LEADERSHIP

= FUTURE - READY PROFESSIONAL

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)





World Athletics Championships in Berlin, Germany

Usain St. Leo Bolt, born 21 Aug, 1986 is a Jamaican retired sprinter. Widely regarded as the greatest sprinter of all time, he is an eight-time Olympic gold medalist & the world record holder in the 100 metres, 200 metres & 4 × 100 metres relay.

A Chinese humanoid robot named **Tiangong Ultra** ran 100 meters in **8.64 seconds** at the *World Humanoid Robot Games* in Beijing on **August 26, 2026**, beating Usain Bolt's human world record of 9.58 seconds.

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)



China is taking a major step toward a future built around AI, robotics & new skills.

At the World Humanoid Robot Games in Beijing, a Chinese humanoid robot called Tiangong Ultra recently ran 100 meters in 8.64 seconds, faster than Usain Bolt's human world record of 9.58 seconds.

More than 2,000 robots took part in the event, which also tested robots in practical activities such as industrial work, household tasks and emergency response.

China is changing how students prepare for the future. Its education authorities are pushing AI into classrooms, expanding AI literacy across different levels of education 7 using AI tools for more personalized learning.

China's 2026 education priorities specifically call for deeper AI integration across teaching, learning & education management.

The country is also moving humanoid robots beyond demonstrations & toward real-world use, with a national initiative targeting the commercial **rollout of 10,000 humanoid robots by the end of 2026.**

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

2026 & onward: **It's all in the hands.**

In 2026, the World Humanoid Robot Games add a challenge for **robotic hands.**

Robots will be judged on their speed & accuracy in precision tasks: tightening screws, opening bottles & picking up beads with tweezers.

Analysts say engineering a hand is the most complex challenge for building a humanoid that can work with the precision & touch of a human.

China's robot games have transformed from academic contests to national showcases.

These competitions now highlight commercial product development & technological advancements.

By 2023, companies like Xiaomi displayed affordable robot dogs at these events.

Future competitions in 2025 & 2026 will test humanoid robots in complex tasks.

State support & a **strong supply chain** drive China's rapid robotics progress.

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

Reuters Last Updated: Aug 22, 2026, 11:08:00 AM IST

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)



Pothole deaths rise 53% in 5 years; UP accounts for over half of 9,400 fatalities

PTI • Last Updated: Feb 13, 2026, 07:50:00 PM IST

Synopsis
Pothole-related road accident deaths have increased by 53% over the past five years, with 9,438 fatalities recorded nationwide between 2020 and 2024, the government told Parliament. Uttar Pradesh accounted for over 54% of the deaths, reporting 5,127 fatalities during the period, including 1,369 in 2024, the highest in the country.

UTI BSE India Sector Leaders Index Fund
Exposure to sector leaders:
Invest across leading companies from multiple sectors through a single fund.



AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)





Gaurav Sen, founder of **InterviewReady**, is building a system that turns pothole detection into ready-to-file civic complaints.

How the App Works

- **Captures Data:** Uses a car dashcam, GPS, & an accelerometer to record road conditions while driving.
- **Processes with AI:** Applies AI vision models to spot & size potholes.
- **Finds Responsibility:** Scans 2,900 Govt. contracts to find the specific contractor & officer responsible for fixing that road.
- **Sends Report:** Generates a complete, ready-to-file complaint with a photo & location in just **4 seconds.**

AI reshapes India's IT services sector contracts as clients demand more for less

Tata Consultancy Services, Infosys, Wipro, HCLTech and Cognizant are rejigging business models, increasingly tying fees to performance outcomes instead of hours worked

Updated – August 23, 2026 05:11 pm IST

REUTERS

These days, pricing for contracts is more likely to be dictated by performance outcomes.
AI promised to disrupt India's IT industry, and it is delivering.



AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

Indian IT's decades-old billing model is starting to change.

- **TCS says 80% of its new finance & HR contracts are now priced based on outcomes, not hours worked.**
- **AI is breaking the old link between time spent & value delivered — and other IT giants are moving in the same direction.**

The bigger lesson for every service business: the future may be about selling results, not time.



With AI, the fundamentals are shifting, Cognizant said in a statement to Reuters, "Clients now expect more value & measurable outcomes, and we are re-forging our model for that reality."

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)



The CEO of German robotics company Neura Robotics believes that **physical AI could replace human labor in less than 5 years.**

David Reger, the founder of Neura Robotics, called the pace of physical AI development & robotics as "tremendous."



AI > Apple Intelligence

‘Physical AI and robotics will take every physical task in the next 2-5 years’: Neura Robotics CEO says writing on the wall for human labor

News By Scott Younker | Published August 21, 2026

“There will be no exceptions."

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

Students Who Built, Failed, Innovated & Changed Society



1. **Pawan Kumar Chandana —**
   From 51 in Maths to Rockets

51 Marks in Mathematics. 100% belief in himself.

Pawan Kumar Chandana struggled academically in mathematics early on, reportedly scoring **51/100**.

He went on to IIT Kharagpur, worked at ISRO & later co-founded Skyroot Aerospace.

Skyroot's journey eventually led to **Vikram-1**, India's first privately built orbital rocket, reaching space in 2026.

SKYROOT AEROSPACE

Your marks measure performance in an examination. They do not measure the size of your dream.

Lesson: Don't confuse academic performance with human potential.

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

Students Who Built, Failed, Innovated & Changed Society

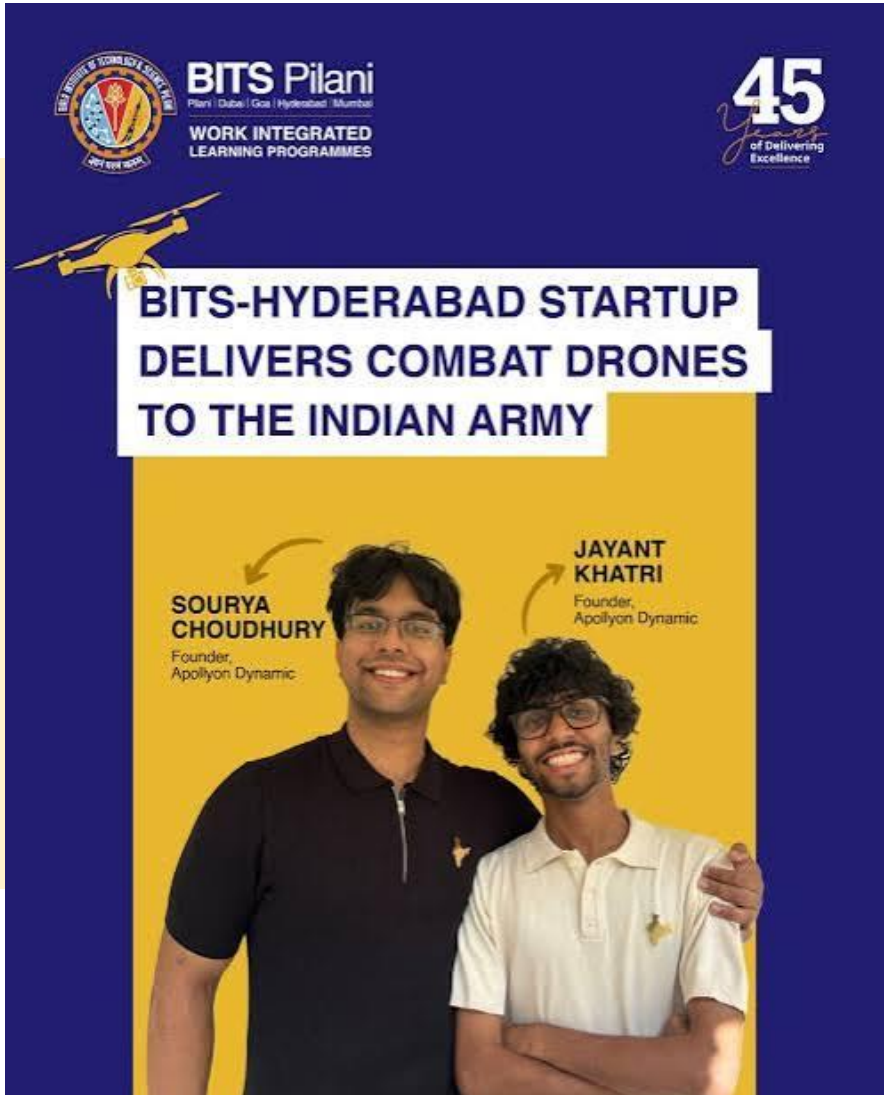
🚀 **2. BITS Pilani Students —**
From Hostel Room to Indian Army

Jayant Khatri & Sourya Choudhury began developing *high-speed defence drones* from their hostel room.

Their student project evolved into **Apollyon Dynamics**, and the technology was demonstrated to Indian Army units. Reports said the Army subsequently placed orders.

Innovation doesn't always begin in a laboratory. Sometimes it begins in a hostel room.
Lesson: Don't wait for permission to solve a problem.

20-year-old students
↓
Student club
↓
Prototype
↓
Army demonstration
↓
Defence startup



AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

WHAT DO THESE STUDENTS HAVE IN COMMON?

Not necessarily:

❌ Highest marks
❌ Perfect CV
❌ Unlimited resources
❌ Big offices
❌ Huge teams

But:

✅ **Curiosity**
✅ **Problem-solving**
✅ **Courage to experiment**
✅ **Ability to build**
✅ **Persistence**
✅ **Collaboration**
✅ **Purpose**



Industry Expectations

Companies are no longer hiring degrees. They are hiring **skills, adaptability, business acumen** & the ability to create **measurable value.**





Recent hiring trends show.. employers increasingly prioritize ***demonstrated skills, work experience & AI readiness*** over traditional credentials alone.

Industry Expectations..

Entry-level hiring is tougher than ever!

- **81%** of employers expect to **prioritize experience in assessing skills for hiring,** prompting universities to deepen work-integrated learning within degree pathways.
- HEI's are building on existing strengths, from work-based learning to **AI-enabled assessment that connect learning with real work.**
- **Strengthening the signals** between learning & hiring, and advancing coordinated action among ***universities, employers and policymakers.***



What Industry Expects Today?

Technical Skills

- ✓ AI Literacy
- ✓ Data Analytics
- ✓ Digital Business
- ✓ Financial Acumen
- ✓ Technology Adoption



What Industry Expects Today?



Human Skills

- ✓ Critical Thinking
- ✓ Problem Solving
- ✓ Communication
- ✓ Leadership
- ✓ Collaboration
- ✓ Emotional Intelligence

What Industry Expects Today?

Mindset

- ✓ Learning Agility
- ✓ Innovation
- ✓ Ownership
- ✓ Customer Centricity
- ✓ Ethics





What Industry Expects Today?

2026 Insight – LI & WEF

Employers increasingly value ***Analytical Thinking, Leadership, Technological Literacy, Communication & AI-related capabilities.***



Domain – wise Industry Expectations

Marketing	HR	Finance	Operations
AI Marketing	AI in HR	Financial Analytics	Supply Chain Analytics
Brand Strategy	Talent Acquisition	Business Partnering	Lean Management
Customer Experience	Employee Experience	AI-enabled FP&A	Automation
Digital Marketing	HR Analytics	Risk Management	Project Management
Marketing Analytics	Learning & Development	ESG Reporting	Quality & Six Sigma

Industry Examples

Marketing

- ✓ AI-powered Campaigns
- ✓ Performance Marketing
- ✓ Creator Economy





HR

- ❖ Skills-based Hiring
- ❖ AI Recruiting
- ❖ Employee Experience

Industry Examples

Finance

- Predictive Analytics
- AI-assisted Forecasting
- Business Partnering



Operations

- Industry 4.0
- Smart Manufacturing
- Digital Supply Chains

AI is augmenting work across business functions, making **digital fluency & data-driven decision-making** essential.

Skills That Make Graduates Employable

MUST HAVE

- ✅ AI Tools *(ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Gemini)*
- ✅ Advanced Excel
- ✅ Power BI / Tableau
- ✅ Presentation Skills
- ✅ Business Writing
- ✅ Data Interpretation
- ✅ Project Management
- ✅ Negotiation



Skills That Make Graduates Employable

NICE TO HAVE

- Python, SQL
- Prompt Engineering
- Design Thinking
- Agile
- Digital Marketing
- Financial Modelling



Micro-credentials developed with industry partners are increasingly valued & employers report **better performance** from graduates who hold them.

What Top Companies Look For



Learning Agility



Digital Skills

amazon

Customer Obsession



AI + Consulting Mindset

Deloitte.

Problem Solving

Infosys

Continuous Learning

Unilever

Growth Mindset



Innovation + Collaboration

The Winning Formula?



Skills × Attitude × Execution × Ethics = Employability

Continuous Upskilling has become a **leadership expectation** as AI reshapes roles & creates new ones.

The Future Belongs To Those Who...

- ✓ Learn Faster
- ✓ Adapt Faster
- ✓ Solve Problems
- ✓ Communicate Better
- ✓ Lead with Integrity
- ✓ Use AI Responsibly





Degree gets you an interview. **Skills** get you the job.

Your **attitude** builds your career.

Your **continuous learning** defines your FUTURE!

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

AI won't replace everyone. People who know how to use AI will increasingly outperform people who don't.

The competitive advantage is moving from access to information to the ability to turn intelligence into action.

Prompting is not the future skill. Problem framing is.

AI can recommend. Humans remain accountable.

Your degree may get you the interview. Your ability to create value with AI may get you the job.



NETWORKING IS THE NEW CAREER CAPITAL



✓ **Your Degree Opens Doors.**
✓ **Your Network Opens More Doors.**
✓ **Your Reputation Keeps Them Open.**

LinkedIn = Your Professional Identity in Public

🎓 Don't just collect a degree — build a professional identity
🤝 Connect before you need help
💡 Learn from people outside your classroom
🌍 Build a network beyond your college, city & country
📢 Share what you learn — don't wait until you become an expert
🚀 Show your projects, ideas, internships & achievements
🔄 Give value before asking for opportunities



CONNECT → LEARN → CONTRIBUTE → BUILD → GET NOTICED

AI-Powered MBA: GenAI – Business, Jobs & Leadership (2026)

START BUILDING YOUR PROFESSIONAL NETWORK — TODAY

Don't wait until your final semester.

Follow people who:

- Inspire you
- Challenge your thinking
- Work in industries you want to enter
- Share knowledge you can learn from
- Are building the future





Don't use LinkedIn only when you are looking for a job. Use it to become the person recruiters want to find.

And remember:
Your LinkedIn profile is not your online CV.
It is your **professional reputation in public.**

My advice to every student:

- ✓ **Follow.**
- ✓ **Learn.**
- ✓ **Comment.**
- ✓ **Create.**
- ✓ **Connect.**

Industry Expectations – Core Management Graduates



LET'S STAY CONNECTED

Regularly share ideas on:

AI • HR • Leadership • Employability • Future of Work • Education

May not be able to mentor everyone personally, but I can continue sharing ideas that may **help you become future-ready.**

Stay curious. Keep learning. And when you build something that creates impact, tag me….I would love to see it. ☺


Q&A
THANK YOU !